

Adding Videos & Blog Posts

Guide for Alan

Your website has a built-in “control room” called the **Studio**. It’s where you add new videos, write blog posts, and update content. This guide walks you through it one step at a time.

OPEN THE STUDIO HERE

www.alanxai.com/studio

Sign in with your usual details. It’s worth bookmarking this page so it’s easy to find next time.

The golden rule: Draft vs Published

Nothing you type appears on the live website until you press **Publish**. Until then, your work is saved privately as a **Draft** that only you can see. So feel free to experiment - the live site stays exactly as it is until *you* decide it’s ready. When you’re happy, press the blue **Publish** button at the bottom-right.

How the screen is laid out

When you open the Studio you’ll see three columns, left to right:

Left (“Content”) - the main areas of your site: **Portfolio**, **Blog**, **Services**, and so on. Pick one to start.

Middle - the list of items inside whatever you picked (all your videos, or all your blog posts).

Right - the form where you actually type and edit. This is where the work happens.

Spotting what’s live: next to each item is a small dot. A **green dot** means it’s live on the site. A **grey dot** means it’s a draft, or has changes you haven’t published yet.

1 Add a new video

Your showreels and films live in the **Portfolio** area.

- 1 In the left “Content” column, click **Portfolio**.
- 2 At the top of the middle list, click the **+** button.
A fresh, blank form opens on the right.
- 3 **Title** - type a name for the video.
e.g. “ALANXAI - AI Showreel 2026”. This is the name people see on the site.
- 4 **Slug** - click **Generate**.
This makes the web-address version of the title for you. You don’t need to change it.
- 5 **Category** - open the dropdown and choose the best fit.
e.g. AI Video, Short Film, Aerial, Animation.
- 6 Add the video. Easiest way: paste your Vimeo link into the **Video URL** box.
 - A YouTube link, or a direct MP4 link, works in the same box too.
 - The **Vimeo URL** box just above also works - either one is fine, you don’t need both.
 - You only need **Video File Upload** if the video *isn’t* online anywhere.

7 **Thumbnail** - the still image shown before the video plays.

Click **Select** or **Upload** and choose a nice frame. Optional, but it looks much better with one.

8 **Description** - a short line shown when someone hovers over the video.

Keep it brief - a sentence is plenty.

9 **Year** - type the year, e.g. 2026.

10 Press **Publish** (bottom-right). That's it - it's now on your site.

In short: if you can watch the video online, just paste its link. That's by far the simplest route.

2 Write a blog post

Blog posts live in the **Blog** area.

1 In the left column, click **Blog**, then **Blog Posts**.

2 Click the **+** at the top of the posts list.

A fresh, blank post opens on the right.

3 **Title** - the headline of your post.

4 **Slug** - click **Generate** (same as before; it builds the web address for you).

5 **Published At** - the date shown on the post.

It fills in today's date automatically - leave it unless you want a different date.

6 **Excerpt** - a short preview, a sentence or two.

This is what people read in the blog list before they click in.

7 **Main Image** - the big photo at the top of the post.

Click **Select** or **Upload**. (Optional: **Image Link URL** lets that image link somewhere, e.g. a Vimeo video. Leave blank if not needed.)

8 **Primary Category** - pick the main topic.

e.g. AI, Film, Aerial. Click the field and choose one.

9 **Categories** - optional extra tags if the post fits more than one topic.

Click **+ Add item** and pick from the list.

10 **Body** - the main article. Type away.

The little toolbar above the text lets you:

- make text **bold** (**B**) or italic (**i**)
- add bullet or numbered lists
- add a link (the chain icon)
- drop in an **Image**
- embed a **YouTube** video

11 When you're happy, press **Publish**.

Your work saves itself as a draft. Close the tab and come back any time - you'll find it waiting in the **Blog Posts** list with a grey dot.

3 A quick note on Categories

Categories are just the topic tags (AI, Aerial, Film, Documentary...). Most of the time you'll simply pick from the existing list.

If you ever need a brand-new one:

- 1 Click **Blog** → **Categories** .
- 2 Click the **+** at the top.
- 3 Type a **Title** , click **Generate** for the slug, then **Publish** .
It'll now appear as an option whenever you tag posts and videos.

4 Good to know

Saving for later

Everything saves automatically as a draft - there's no "save" button to hunt for. Just close it and return when you like.

Editing something that's already live

Click the item, make your change, and press **Publish** again to update it.

Taking something down

Open the item, click the **...** (more) menu near the top-right, and choose **Unpublish**. It leaves the site but stays safely in your list.

Green dot vs grey dot

Green = live on the site. Grey = a draft, or changes waiting for you to **Publish** .

Any questions, just give me a shout and I'll happily talk you through it.

- Alex